



Introduction to Artificial Intelligence (INTRAI)

Module 1: What is AI?

What is Artificial Intelligence

Lesson Notes

KMVTECHUG

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What Is Artificial Intelligence?

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is the field of computer science that aims to build systems that can perform tasks that normally require human intelligence. Those tasks include recognising patterns, understanding language, making decisions, and learning from experience.

You already use AI even if you never open a programming tool. When your phone suggests the next word as you type, when a banking app flags a suspicious mobile-money transfer, or when a map app suggests a faster route around Kampala traffic, an AI system is helping in the background.

Narrow and General AI

Narrow AI (also called weak AI) is designed for a specific task. Face unlock, spam filters, and crop-disease image classifiers are narrow systems. Almost all AI you meet today is narrow.

General AI would handle a wide range of tasks at human-like flexibility. That does not exist yet in a practical form. News headlines sometimes blur this difference. When someone says the AI will take over, ask: which task, with which data, under whose control?

AI Around You in Uganda

Local examples include mobile money and banking risk scoring, telecom chatbots, agriculture pilots that help identify crop disease from phone photos, health screening support with human oversight, and education tools on campus.

Your role as a student is to recognise when a system uses data and prediction, what it needs to work well, and what can go wrong when data is biased or incomplete.

Reflect: Name one AI-powered feature you used this week. Was it narrow AI? What task was it doing?

Closing

This lesson defined AI, separated narrow from general systems, and located AI in everyday Ugandan digital life. The next lesson covers history, myths, and realistic limits.